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LETTERS TO MY SON

On Wealth

16 letters

Father

A father's letters, worth keeping.

A word before you begin

My son,

Money is a good servant and a cruel master. These letters are on building a fortune that frees you rather than owns you.

Read one a day. Sit with it. Let it change one small thing in how you live.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Cheerful poverty is an honourable thing.

It is not the man who has too little, but the man who craves more, who is poor.

Want less, and you are already richer than most.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

No man is poor who has enough; no man is rich who fears losing it.

Wealth is measured by what you can do without, not what you have stored.

Own your needs before you chase your wants.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

It is the mind that makes a man rich.

Gold in the chest changes nothing if the man holding the key is still hungry.

Build the inner fortune first; the rest is decoration.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The loudest fortunes are often the most fragile.

Real, lasting wealth is quiet, patient, and built to
outlive its builder.

Build to last, not to be seen.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The great man is the one who stays poor in the midst of riches.

To hold much and need none of it is the only wealth no thief can reach.

Be the man who could lose it all and still stand.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Pay your own debts with your own hand.

What you delegate carelessly, others quietly skim. Stay close to your own money.

Keep your hand on what is yours.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

A family's wealth is human, intellectual, and only lastly financial.

The accounts are the smallest part. The people and what they know are the fortune.

Grow the first two and the third follows.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

It is the mind, not the coffer, that makes a man rich.

Gold in the chest changes nothing if the man holding the key still hungers.

Build the inner fortune first; the rest is ornament.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Practice poverty a few days, so you never fear it.

Taste the bare floor of life and the fear of falling leaves
you.

Rehearse having little; it frees you to risk much.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

A family's true wealth is its people, then its knowledge,
and only last its money.

The accounts are the smallest part of the fortune.

Grow the first two and the third takes care of itself.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

The loud fortune is the fragile one.

Real wealth is quiet, slow, and built to outlast the man
who made it.

Build to last, not to be seen.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Inherited money without inherited wisdom is a curse in a gift's clothing.

Hand a fortune to an unprepared heir and you hand him his undoing.

Prepare the heir long before the inheritance.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

He who needs least is nearest to the gods.

Every want you conquer is a chain you remove yourself.

Shrink the wanting and watch the wealth appear.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Set a limit on your desires before the world sets none.

Riches measured against endless want will always read as poverty.

Decide what is enough, and then defend it.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

Money skips the heir who was handed everything and prepared for nothing.

The unready hand drops the fortune the ready hand would have grown.

Prepare the person long before the inheritance.

Yours faithfully,

Father

My dear son,

A gift that removes the need to strive is not a gift but a quiet harm.

Give your son the means and the reason to build, never the excuse to stop.

Hand him a ladder, not a hammock.

Yours faithfully,

Father

Keep going

If these served you, there is more.

- A new letter every day — @letters_to_son_eng
- The weekly letter — comment LETTERS to join.
- The full collection and printed keepsakes — coming soon.

Carry these well. One day you may write your own.

Yours faithfully,

Father